

Q1 What do the parting words “See you soon Amma” signify?

- (A) her carelessness
- (B) Her optimistic farewell full of cheerfulness
- (C) she bids goodbye like this
- (D) she is in a hurry

Q2 What does the phrase “smile and smile and smile” signify?

- (A) The poet is extremely happy
- (B) She is forcing herself to smile despite feeling sad
- (C) She is laughing loudly
- (D) She is mocking her mother

Q3 What does the contrast between “sprinting trees” and “pale mother” signify?

- (A) The beauty of nature
- (B) The contrast between youth and old age
- (C) The poet’s happiness
- (D) The changing seasons

Q4 What realization strikes the poet while traveling?

- (A) That her mother is lonely
- (B) That her mother is growing old and frail
- (C) That she should visit more often
- (D) That her mother needs medical attention

Q5 How does the poet feel while looking at her mother?

- (A) Angry
- (B) Worried and sorrowful
- (C) Happy
- (D) Indifferent

Q6 Why does the poet look at the trees and children outside?

- (A) She enjoys nature
- (B) She wants to distract herself from her painful thoughts
- (C) She loves watching children play
- (D) She is tired of looking at her mother

Q7 What is the tone of the poem?

- (A) Humorous
- (B) Sad and reflective
- (C) Indifferent
- (D) Excited

Q8 What does the poet notice about her mother while sitting beside her in the car?

- (A) She is sleeping peacefully
- (B) She looks young and cheerful
- (C) She has turned pale and lifeless like a corpse
- (D) She is reading a book

Q9 What does the phrase “familiar ache” signify?

- (A) A constant headache
- (B) The poet’s habitual sadness over her mother’s aging
- (C) A physical pain the poet feels
- (D) A longing for childhood memories

Q10 What does the phrase “wan, pale” suggest about the poet’s mother?

- (A) She is cheerful
- (B) She is weak and aging
- (C) She is excited
- (D) She is angry



Answer Key

Q1 B
Q2 B
Q3 B
Q4 B
Q5 B

Q6 B
Q7 B
Q8 C
Q9 B
Q10 B



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Hints & Solutions

Note: scan the QR code to watch video solution

Q1 Text Solution:

In *My Mother at Sixty-Six* by Kamala Das, the poet says **"See you soon, Amma"** as she bids farewell to her aging mother. Although she feels deep sorrow and fear of losing her mother, she chooses to **hide her emotions and express hope instead**. These words reflect an **optimistic and cheerful farewell**, even though internally, she is struggling with the pain of separation and the realization of her mother's frailty.

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Video Solution:



Q2 Text Solution:

The repetition of "smile" emphasizes the poet's forced cheerfulness to hide her pain.

Video Solution:



Q3 Text Solution:

"Sprinting trees" symbolize youth and life, while the mother's paleness represents aging and approaching death.

Video Solution:



Q4 Text Solution:

The poet suddenly realizes how old and fragile her mother has become, filling her with sadness.

Video Solution:



Q5 Text Solution:

The poet is filled with worry and sorrow, realizing her mother's age and the fear of losing her.

Video Solution:



Q6 Text Solution:

To avoid confronting the painful reality of her mother's aging, she shifts her focus to the vibrant life outside, symbolizing contrast between youth and old age.

Video Solution:**Q7 Text Solution:**

The poem has a sad and reflective tone, as the poet contemplates aging, separation, and mortality.

Video Solution:**Q8 Text Solution:**

The poet observes her mother's pale, weak face, comparing it to a lifeless body, symbolizing aging and approaching death.

Video Solution:**Q9 Text Solution:**

"Familiar ache" refers to the poet's deep, recurring pain of knowing that one day she will lose her mother.

Video Solution:**Q10 Text Solution:**

The phrase "**wan, pale**" suggests that the poet's mother **is weak and aging** (Option **B**).

In *My Mother at Sixty-Six* by Kamala Das, the poet describes her mother's face as "**wan, pale as a late winter's moon,**" highlighting her frailty and old age. The comparison to a winter's moon symbolizes dullness and lack of vitality, indicating that the mother is growing weaker and nearing the end of her life. This realization fills the poet with sorrow and a fear of losing her mother.

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